

Many AeJ central banks sold USD in June following the FOMC's perceived hawkishness

BOK, BI and BSP may have bucked the trend on local factors.

- Our estimates suggest that the CBC, BOT, RBI, MAS and PBoC have sold FX/USD in June to lean against USD strength following the FOMC's perceived hawkishness at its June meeting.
- The BOK accumulated spot FXR in June despite USD/KRW being ~2.9% higher, but this could have been offset by forward selling (June data are not yet available), as was observed in October and November 2025. It might have also been due to stronger exporter repatriation in June.
- BI's back-to-back 25bp *hikes* in June and *measures* to attract bond inflows may have given BI scope to accumulate FX/USD in June.
- We estimate the RBI sold USD2.6bn of spot FX reserves (FXR) in June, despite introducing measures to attract inflows at its June MPC meeting.
- We estimate the BOT net sold USD2.7bn of FXR (spot + forward; ~1.1% of FXR) in June to lean against THB depreciation pressures.

Key observations

- In **India**, we estimate the **RBI continued to net sell spot FXR in June**, though at a slower pace of USD2.6bn, less than half of the USD5.7bn of spot FXR selling in May 2026. Several factors contributed to this slower pace, including: a) the *US-Iran interim deal* with the associated lower oil prices and the RBI's announced *measures* for attracting capital inflows - *FCNR(B)* and ECB.
 - The RBI's net short forward book expanded by USD11.4bn in May 2026 to a record level of USD106.7bn. This included the USD5.0bn FX swap conducted by the RBI on 26 May. In the coming months, the RBI's net short forward book is likely to expand further as it enters FX swaps at concessional rates with banks because of FCNR(B) and ECB inflows.
- In **Indonesia**, we estimate that the **BI net accumulated USD2.6bn** (spot + forwards) in June (~2.1% of May FXR), even after adjusting for FX valuations, coupon receipts and FX bond issuance and maturities, and FX term deposits. Arguably, BI's back-to-back 25bp *hikes* in June and *measures* to attract bond inflows might have given BI scope to augment its weak FX reserves position – we saw IndoGBs inflows of USD1.3bn in June and SRBI inflows of USD1.2bn from 1 to 15 June (last available).
 - In its statement, BI also noted that the slight increase in its FXR was “primarily attributable to tax and services receipts...” (BI, 7 July).
- In **Korea**, we estimate the **BOK net bought USD3.0bn of spot FXR** in June (0.7% of May FXR) after adjustments. The BOK's press release (*BOK*, 3 July) highlighted that despite market stabilization measures (such as the FX swaps with the NPS), headline FXR rose only slightly, driven by “factors including an increase in foreign currency deposits at financial institutions” (i.e., +USD0.9bn). We note that local media (*Pulse*, 12 June) highlighted that the Korea government had requested major corporates to convert their FX holdings into KRW in June.
 - This estimated net accumulation in spot FXR emerged despite KRW being the worst performing AeJ currency in June (i.e., USD/KRW was ~2.9% higher) with onshore spot USD/KRW trading as high as 1,562.2 on 5 June.

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- That said, we **await the June forward book data to gauge actual FX intervention** (i.e., spot + forward) by the BOK in June. In October and November 2025, when KRW was also under significant depreciation pressure, we estimated the BOK net accumulated USD7.7bn and USD0.4bn in spot FXR, respectively, after adjustments. However, the forward book released later showed a m-o-m decline of USD7.3bn and USD7.0bn in October and November, respectively. This showed that the BOK had intervened in the forward market to slow the pace of KRW depreciation.
- In **Thailand**, we estimate the BOT **net sold USD2.7bn of FXR** (1.1% of May FXR; spot + forward) in June to lean against THB depreciation pressure. THB was one of the worst underperforming AeJ currencies after KRW, with THB 2.1% weaker against USD in June.
 - We believe that BOT is increasingly concerned about THB underperformance. In the minutes from the June MPC meeting (held between 19 and 24 June 2026), some MPC raised questions regarding the stability of THB (**BOT**, 8 July). On 8 July, as spot THB weakened above the 33.5 level against USD, the BOT said it was closely monitoring THB and stood ready to intervene (*Bloomberg*, 8 July).
- In **China**, we estimate the **PBoC net sold a relatively small USD0.7bn of FXR** (spot only) in June 2026, with spot USD/CNH slightly higher by 0.3% in the month. While June data are not available yet, we estimate that state banks may have accumulated a modest USD0.2bn of FX deposits, suggesting that their FX deposit accumulation momentum (March to May monthly average: +USD13.1bn) likely stalled in June amid the USD bid environment.

Fig. 1: Estimated intervention by AeJ central banks^[1] in June

(USD bn)	CN	IN	ID	KR	PH	SG	TW	TH
June 2026 FX Reserves (USD bn)	3416	541	125	403	83	412	597	242
June intervention (spot & forward)	-0.7	-2.6	2.6	3.0	1.0	-2.3	-7.1	-2.7
June intervention as % of May FXR	0.0%	-0.5%	2.1%	0.7%	1.3%	-0.5%	-1.2%	-1.1%
Month of recent peak in FX reserves	May-26	Aug-25	Dec-25	Nov-25	Oct-25	May-26	Feb-26	Feb-26
Drawdown after the recent peak in FX reserves (spot & forward)	-0.7	-105.4	-19.0	-17.5	-10.8	-2.3	-12.2	-3.7
Interv. since recent intensification in drawdown (spot & forward) % of FXR	0.0%	-18.0%	-14.1%	-4.3%	-12.1%	-0.5%	-2.0%	-1.5%
2026 YTD Interv. as % of end 2025 FXR	1.6%	-11.1%	-14.1%	-2.1%	-10.0%	-1.9%	-2.6%	-0.8%
2026 YTD Interv. as % of GDP	0.3%	-1.6%	-1.3%	-0.4%	-1.8%	-1.3%	-1.7%	-0.3%
2025 Interv. as % of end 2024 FXR	-2.4%	-8.4%	-17.4%	-7.1%	-7.7%	3.9%	1.3%	8.5%
2024 Interv. as % of end 2023 FXR	-0.3%	-15.0%	-0.2%	-2.8%	-7.5%	8.6%	-2.9%	2.6%
June foreign equity flow (A)	-	-3.0	-1.1	-30.5	0.0	-	-18.3	0.2
June foreign bond flow (B)	-	5.6	1.3	9.1	-	-	-	0.5
Basic Balance monthly average (C)	50.4	-6.6	-0.6	22.2	-1.0	14.3	11.7	1.2
Current Account monthly average	52.0	-3.9	-2.8	29.5	-1.9	9.6	12.4	-4.6
FDI monthly average	-4.3	-0.8	1.1	-2.5	0.5	5.7	-3.1	0.8
Total of BB and foreign equity and bond flow (A+B+C)	50.4	-4.0	-0.5	0.8	-1.0	14.3	-6.5	1.9
USD/Asia in June	0.3%	-0.4%	0.2%	2.9%	-0.4%	1.3%	1.5%	2.1%
Average Reserve Adequacy	96%	222%	91%	76%	150%	58%	110%	242%
Average Reserve Adequacy with a fixed exchange rate regime	70%	182%	73%	61%	118%	54%	89%	187%

Note: FX reserves data (spot and forward) is for June 2026 or the latest available. We have used actual FX intervention data where available for the BOK (to Q1 2026), CBC (to Q1 2026), the MAS (to H2 2025), and the RBI (to April 2026). FX forwards for June are available for the CBC and BOT, based on our estimates for BI (using FX swaps), and unavailable for the RBI, PBoC, BOK, BSP and MAS (i.e., only using adjusted spot reserves). The recent peak in FX reserves is the peak of headline FX reserves in the last 12 months. Bond data for Thailand from the BOT. India bond flow data from WFII. CA is based on Q2 2026 (Nomura forecast), divided by 3. FDI is last 4Q average divided by 4. Basic Balance is the sum of CA and FDI. Reserve Adequacy as of June 2026.

Source: CEIC, Bloomberg, Nomura.

- For BOK spot intervention, we adjusted for FX valuations, coupons receipts and FX bond issuance and maturities. For MAS spot intervention, we adjusted for FX valuations, coupon receipts and outstanding amount of Reserves Management Government Securities. For BI spot intervention, we adjusted for FX valuations, coupon receipts and FX bond issuance and maturities, FX term deposits, and government foreign currency loans. FX forwards for June are available for the CBC (-USD0.7bn) and BOT (+USD0.13bn), and based on our estimates for BI (using FX swaps; -USD2.8bn).

Appendix A-1

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